

Stakeholder Decision Update

Student: ALIA ISLAM

Variant ID: D4-A

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Decision

- ☐ Proceed
- ☒ Proceed conditionally
- ☐ Block pending clarification

Message To Founder:

Respected Founder,

Quick update on the recruiter override request.

I've scoped what's safe to build and what isn't.

I'm ready to move but I need one answer before writing a single line.

The request is: let recruiters shortlist candidates manually, even if the

AI score is low. That's clear. What's NOT clear is whether this action needs a reason attached to it.

My one question:

Should the recruiter be required to give a reason when overriding or is a one-click silent shortlist acceptable for the pilot?

This matters because:

- Without a reason: we have no audit trail. If a bias question comes up during or after the pilot, we have no defense.
- With a reason (even optional): we have a paper trail at zero extra cost.

While I wait, here's what I'm treating as safe to proceed on:

- One "Shortlist" button per candidate
- Short optional reason field
- Server-side log (recruiter, candidate, timestamp, reason if given)
- AI score stays visible, labeled separately from shortlist status
- Recruiter can undo their own shortlist

What I am NOT building before your answer:

- Permissions tiers or manager approval
- Audit dashboard
- Bulk shortlist
- Candidate-facing notifications

This keeps us moving without creating risk we can't walk back. Respond with your call on the reason field and I'll have a scope document ready same day.

Yours sincerely,
Alia Islam

Key Ambiguity

Is a reason required when a recruiter overrides an AI score?

This is the most dangerous unclear point because it determines:

- Whether the feature is audit-safe on day one
- Whether unexplained shortlisting creates fairness exposure
- Whether the pilot creates legal or reputational risk at scale

Every other ambiguity (who can override, is override reversible) is secondary to this.

Clarification Question

When a recruiter overrides an AI score to shortlist a candidate, should a reason be required or is a silent one-click override acceptable for the pilot?

Why this question: It resolves audit risk, fairness risk, and UI scope in one answer. All other open questions become easier once this is settled.

Safe Assumptions

Assumption	Why It Is Safe Enough	What Could Break It
All pilot recruiters have equal override access	Pilot has a small trusted cohort; no hierarchy needed yet	If some recruiters shouldn't have this power, access is uncontrolled
Override reason is optional but captured if provided	Reduces friction; still builds audit foundation	Blank reasons leave gaps if override is challenged post-pilot
AI score stays visible after manual shortlist	Preserves trust and transparency with zero extra cost	If recruiter expects AI score to disappear, UI will confuse them

Scope Boundary

Will not build:

- Role-based permissions system
- Manager approval or override approval workflow
- Audit/analytics dashboard
- Bulk override capability
- Candidate notification on shortlist

Why:

None of these were requested. All of them introduce complexity, design time, and new ambiguities that can't be resolved before the pilot deadline. The AI recommendation to build all of these is an overbuild trap, it sounds complete but delays the one thing the founder actually needs: a recruiter who feels in control during the pilot. The minimal v1 covers the core need safely. Everything else is post-pilot scope.